Austin Novak

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EDUCATION

University of Wisconsin–Madison

B.S. in Cartography and Geographic Information Systems + People-Environment Geography

EXPERIENCE

Cartographer and GIS Analyst **May 2023 - Feb 2025**
SE Group *Burlington, VT*

- As the resident cartography and geospatial specialist, assisted a team of 40+ community planners, landscape architects, and environmental analysts with visual communication and GIS tasks, regularly troubleshooting technical problems and providing peers with instruction on GIS software, data management, and cartographic best practices.
- Gathered, validated, and manipulated geospatial data to produce over 100 static maps and graphic deliverables for 24 projects with varying use-cases, data limitations, and design constraints, all while balancing strict budgets, tight deadlines, and multiple concurrent tasks.
- Built a custom database web platform with ArcGIS Maps SDK for JavaScript for a statewide department, using Google Geocoding API to convert thousands of addresses into web-friendly spatial data and coding a custom interactive map to explore, filter, and aggregate by attribute and geography.
- Created interactive maps for 11 projects and the company website, and built online data collection tools for public engagement, including a unique ArcGIS Online public survey platform with custom form logic, nested attributes, and a workflow for summary analysis.
- Built, merged, and fixed dozens of geospatial datasets using geoprocessing tools and scripts, including two regional suitability analyses built on weighted models, and a county-wide future land use layer now used to guide subdivision reviews and policy decisions.

Student Production Cartographer **Jan 2020 - May 2023**
University of Wisconsin Cartography Lab *Madison, WI*

- Completed mapping and GIS projects for authors, publications, nonprofits, and individuals, frequently earning repeat work from satisfied clients.
- Participated in three annual design challenges, including building a K-5 cartography curriculum and mapping complex bird migration data.

Sailing Instructor **2021 - 2022 & May 2026 - Present**
Hoofers Sailing Club *Madison, WI*

- Planned and led group sailing lessons for students of all ages and experience levels, consistently receiving feedback praising effective time management, inclusivity, and a supportive teaching style.

Greenhouse Store Associate **2020 - 2023 & June 2025 - Present**
Madison Greenhouse Store *Madison, WI*

- Performed a wide variety of daily horticultural and retail tasks in a dynamic environment.

AWARDS

North American Cartographic Information Society

- Cartographic Design Winner (Iceland) 2020
- Group Dynamic Map Winner (Dark Sky Sanctuaries) 2022

Wisconsin Land Information Association

- Best Student Map + Runner-up Best Base & Reference Map 2020
- People's Choice Award + Runner-up Best Base & Reference Map 2021
- Runner-up Most Unique Map 2022

TECHNICAL SKILLS

GIS Software ArcGIS Pro, ArcGIS Online Suite, QGIS, Global Mapper, ArcMap

Design Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign, Microsoft Office Suite, Blender, Figma

Programming ArcPy, Python, Arcade, JavaScript, HTML, CSS

Data Visualization Leaflet.js, ArcGIS Maps SDK for JavaScript, Mapbox Studio